BARBELL DEADLIFT

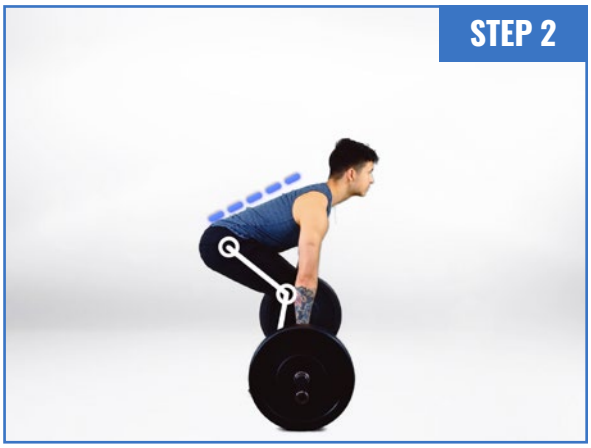
For the barbell deadlift, since the exercise is quite technical, it is recommended that you *watch the exercise tutorial video*.

STEP 1: SETUP

We're going to cover the conventional deadlift, which involves a fairly narrow stance.

Start with a barbell on the ground. If you have access to big bumper plates, load the bar with those. If you aren't going to be using any weight or only have access to smaller weight plates, either elevate the bar onto a rack, weight stack, or any elevated platform so that the bar starts at about the level of your shins.

Stand under the bar with your feet about hip-width apart and toes pointed outwards slightly. When you look down at the bar, it should be directly over your midfoot. Get down to grip the bar by pushing your hips back with a slight bend in your knees. Keep your back straight as you do so, and continue lowering until you're able to reach the bar. With your arms straight, grip the bar with an overhand grip that's about shoulder-width apart, which should be just outside of your knees. Bring the bar as close to your shins as possible and tuck your chin down to align your neck with your spine by gazing at the floor just a few feet in front of you.



STEP 2

Stabilize your body by thinking about bending the bar in half towards you by engaging your lat muscles, and then pull your chest up and hips down to wedge yourself into the bar. From here, brace your core and pull the slack out of the bar by lightly pulling up against it and pushing your feet away from the floor.

From here, while maintaining a straight back and keeping your chest up, pull up on the bar while pushing your feet down against the floor. As you do so, the bar should travel in a perfectly straight line up over your midfoot and should be kept as close to your body as possible. Once the weight passes your knees, drive your hips forward and squeeze your glutes to finish the lift. From here, control the weight back down by first pushing your hips back and then once the weight passes your knees, bending your knees until the weights touch the ground. Again, keep the bar as close to your thighs and knees as possible as you do so. You can choose to either perform touch and go reps, just lightly tapping the ground with the weights each rep, or you can choose to let the weights fully settle on the ground and reset your form before going into the next rep.

ADDITIONAL TIPS

If you still have trouble with rounding your back as you pull, try lightening the weight and also consider elevating the starting position onto weight plates to shorten the range of motion. This is especially helpful for taller individuals or those with certain hip structures that make getting into the deadlift position difficult. You don't need to lift from the floor unless you're planning to compete as a powerlifter.